

ESL 1 Syllabus • Grades 4-8

Mrs. Rasmussen • SY 2026-2027

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?"

Mrs. Rasmussen

English as a Second Language • Grades 4-8 • Mary, Star of the Sea School

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Welcome Parents and Guardians!

I am Mrs. Rasmussen, your child's English as a Second Language teacher. I am a graduate of the University of Hawaii with a Bachelor's in Secondary Education / Social Studies and a minor in Psychology. I have additional coursework in Montessori and Early Childhood Development and am certified to teach preschool through grade 12.

I have spent years substituting in public schools, an orthopedic unit, a deaf and blind school, and special education. I also spent 10 years at Star of the Sea Early Learning Center in preschool and kindergarten. I have tutored students in various subjects since 1978 and have been an ESL teacher at Mary, Star of the Sea since 2006.

I am here to facilitate your child's learning of English as well as support their functioning in the regular classroom. In ESL 1, we work on speaking and oral reading; we write weekly on a variety of topics; and we learn vocabulary words and their usage.

Communication among teachers, students, and parents is essential in learning English. I am grateful for your support and the opportunity to work with your child.

Sincerely,

Mrs. Rasmussen • drasmussen@starofthesea.org

Our Mission

To provide a Christ-centered education that reflects academic excellence and stewardship, and to provide a learning environment where students can foster confidence and social skills and become lifelong learners.

Academics

- Imagine Learning — online reading program used throughout the year.
- Explode the Code — phonics and reinforcement.
- Spelling Skills — vocabulary development at each student's level.
- Language Arts — parts of speech and sentence structure.
- Reading Skills — Facts, Sequence, Context, Main Idea, Conclusion, and Inference.

- Writing Skills — personal narratives, informative writing, descriptive writing, opinion and comparative writing, stories, and short reports.

English as a Second Language — Scope

I. Communication

- Oral and written communication
- Understanding directions
- Listening and following directions

II. Vocabulary & Grammar Usage

- Parts of speech
- Writing in complete sentences
- Mechanics

III. Reading

- Decoding words
- Punctuation & intonation
- Fluency

IV. Comprehension

- Understanding directions & questions
- Responding in complete sentences
- Context clues, Main Idea, details
- Cause & effect, predicting outcomes
- Inference & drawing conclusions

V. Writing

- Sentences, questions, and answers
- Short answers, paragraphs, essays
- Different forms of writing

Homework & Support at Home

- Homework is assigned daily and should take about 20 minutes to complete independently. It is due when the next class is in session.
- Computers and other tools such as dictionaries are allowed.
- I encourage the use of English in the home daily.
- Reading aloud for 20 minutes each day helps students speak English clearly and write in complete sentences.
- Students who need assistance completing assignments may finish their work during lunch recess in my room.

“Let’s work together for a successful year!”